

Istanbul Bariatric Center NEWSLETTER

Vol:0003

Sharing Your Bariatric Surgery Journey



The decision of whether to share the details of your weight loss journey is a personal one, and there's no right or wrong answer. It ultimately comes down to what makes you most comfortable.

Inevitably, you'll share the news with various people, and they can typically be grouped into three categories:

1. Supporters: These are the individuals who offer love, support, encouragement, and are like cheerleaders for your journey. Bariatric surgery is distinct from any diet you've tried before, and when you share your experience, it enables them to understand the unique challenges you face. This understanding allows them to provide support and encouragement tailored to your needs, whether it's choosing healthier options at gatherings or respecting your dietary restrictions.



2. Critics: Some people might express strong opinions about surgery, often due to a lack of knowledge, personal weight struggles, jealousy, or misinformation. It's important to remember that their criticisms don't diminish your ability to succeed post-surgery, and it doesn't validate their responses. Confidence in your decision is key, and your self-worth isn't determined by others' opinions.

3. Relaters: Bariatric surgery is a highly effective long-term treatment for obesity, although it's sometimes overlooked or misunderstood. A significant portion of the world population is overweight or obese. By sharing your experience, you can inspire and motivate others to take control of their health. They may not all choose surgery, but they could be influenced to make healthier lifestyle changes. You might even find a workout partner, a friend to explore farmers' markets with, or someone willing to listen and support you along the way.

Ultimately, the choice to share your journey is personal, and it's about what feels right for you and aligns with your goals and values.



Istanbul Bariatric Center

NEWSLETTER



Bariatric Nutrition Simplified

By the time most individuals go through bariatric surgery, they are already quite familiar with common weight-loss diets. The idea of learning the nuances of yet another eating plan can be daunting for many. The good news is that what you've learned from previous diets will provide a solid foundation for understanding how to eat after bariatric surgery. You don't need to be a nutrition expert to grasp and follow a bariatric eating plan.

Let's go over the fundamental principles for post-surgery eating, which are reflected in the recipes featured in these newsletters.

Hydration is a top priority after bariatric surgery. Drinking enough fluids not only boosts your energy but also plays a vital role in your weight loss journey. Dehydration is the most common complication post-surgery, but it's entirely preventable. Initially, it can be a bit challenging because you can't drink with meals or within 30 minutes before or after eating. To stay on top of your hydration, always keep a beverage with you and sip throughout the day and evening. Avoid trying to catch up later since your smaller pouch restricts chugging large amounts of fluid at once.



Istanbul Bariatric Center

NEWSLETTER



What to Drink: Include water, milk, soy milk, protein shakes, decaffeinated tea or coffee (without added cream or sugar), and any other noncarbonated and sugar-free beverages (those sweetened with sugar substitutes are fine).

Amount per Day: Aim for 64 to 100 ounces, progressing in volume as you move through different post-op diet stages.

What to Limit or Avoid: Limit or avoid juices, caffeinated beverages (such as soda, coffee, tea, and energy drinks), carbonated waters, alcohol, lemonade, sweetened tea, sugary sports drinks, and any beverages sweetened with sugar.

Protein is the star of your post-operative diet. It's the most crucial macronutrient to focus on. Protein serves as the building block for muscle and tissue. Consuming sufficient protein on a very low-calorie diet is essential.

Adequate protein intake boosts your energy, aids in fat loss while preserving muscle, and provides longer post-meal satisfaction. Protein is digested more slowly than carbohydrates and has fewer calories than fats. Initially after surgery, you'll primarily consume water and protein-rich foods.

As you progress, you'll gradually reintroduce mixed meals into your diet. This cookbook provides a variety of ideas to ensure you can enjoy sufficient protein for the long term without getting bored. Eating protein at every meal is essential for not only losing weight initially but also for maintaining long-term weight loss.



Istanbul Bariatric Center

NEWSLETTER



What to Eat: Consider including eggs, poultry (skinless chicken and turkey, lean nitrate-free chicken or turkey sausage, ground chicken, and turkey breast), all types of fish and seafood, low-fat dairy products (like low-fat Greek yogurt, 1 percent or nonfat cottage cheese, and 1 percent or nonfat milk and cheese), lean beef (if tolerated, beginning 3 months post-op; sirloin, loin, round roast or steak, and lean or supreme lean ground beef),

and lean pork (if tolerated, beginning 3 months post-op; tenderloin, top loin chop, and ham with visible fat removed). Additionally, vegetarian protein sources such as beans, nuts, lentils, and seeds can be part of your diet.

Amount per Day: Aim for 60 to 100 grams, but keep in mind that specific recommendations are based on your ideal body weight and the post-operative diet stage you're in.

What to Limit or Avoid: Be cautious with high-fat dairy products (like cream and whole milk), high-fat cuts of beef or pork (such as pork sausage, bacon, bologna, salami, pork ribs, and fatty ground beef), and skin-on poultry.

